95% OF ENTERPRISE AI PROJECTS FAIL THIS EX-GOOGLE ENGINEER IS CHANGING THAT

While 95% of enterprise AI projects collapse before reaching production, Raunak Bhandari spent a decade learning exactly why – and then built the system to fix it.

THE PROBLEM NOBODY HAS SOLVED

Born in Jodhpur, raised in Jaipur, and after clearing IIT JEE through Kota's coaching ecosystem, Bhandari went on to study at IIT Roorkee. Throughout his career, Raunak Bhandari has focused on a recurring problem: closing the gap between AI that works in demos and AI that works in production.

According to an MIT report published in Fortune, 95% of generative AI pilot projects at companies fail to make it past the demo stage. “Impressive demos are the easy part,” says Bhandari. “The moment you run AI at scale with actual customers and workflows, everything breaks. These are non-deterministic systems. Ninety-nine percent of teams don't know how to push accuracy from 70% to 95%.”

A DECADE INSIDE THE MACHINE

An IIT Roorkee graduate, Bhandari's career spans the most consequential AI systems of the past decade. At Google, he led applied research across products serving billions of users daily — giving him deep understanding of what it takes to make AI reliable at planetary scale.

On Google Maps, he tackled coordinated fraud attacks — networks of bad actors manipulating business listings and reviews across millions of businesses globally. The graph-based detection techniques he developed delivered an 18% improvement in identifying fraudulent actors while simultaneously cutting false positives by 41%. The research was presented at Google's Graph AI Summit and produced multiple internal publications that influenced the company's broader anti-fraud strategy.

For Google Search, he developed and launched core ranking deep learning models for Discover, reaching billions of users. He was among the earliest researchers to apply large language models to Google's Knowledge Graph Factuality — the system behind the information boxes that appear alongside search results for billions of queries each day. His approach yielded a 30%+ improvement in factual accuracy. He also contributed to early work on Gemini,



Google's flagship AI system, specifically focused on reducing AI hallucinations — the tendency of models to state falsehoods with confidence.

Before Google, Bhandari had already worked on production AI systems at significant scale. At Embibe, subsequently acquired by Reliance JIO, he led the team that built India's first automated educational knowledge graph — a system that extracted and mapped conceptual relationships across K-12 subjects with 95% accuracy, in a domain where errors mean students learning the wrong thing. At Volterra, acquired by F5 Networks for $500 million, he built AI-powered anomaly detection systems for enterprise network security.

THREE REASONS ENTERPRISE AI BREAKS

Drawing on this experience, Bhandari identifies three fundamental problems behind the 95% failure rate. First, non-determinism: AI models can produce different outputs for identical inputs, and most teams lack the expertise to engineer consistency. Second, context engineering — language models have limited context windows, and performance degrades as more information is crammed in. Third, enterprise data complexity: regulatory requirements and data sovereignty rules that freeze projects the moment they surface.

“I've been in AI for a decade,” Bhandari says. “Working with non-deterministic systems requires a fundamentally different mindset. The hard part isn't building one smart agent — it's building systems where multiple agents work together reliably.”

BUILDING WHAT DIDN'T EXIST

Finding no existing framework that addressed all three problems, Bhandari designed his startup (KiwiQ)'s technical architecture from the ground up — drawing on a decade of deploying AI at billion-user scale and through hundreds of experiments and continuous refinement.

Bhandari built a full-stack platform where over 100 specialised AI agents collaborate to execute complex enterprise workflows. He developed several novel technical contributions implemented at this scale for the first time: a three-tier organisational memory system that enables the AI to learn from every interaction; intelligent context management that delivers precise information to models without overwhelming them; and automated quality control loops that evaluate and refine outputs without human intervention.

“The first blog post requires the most human input,” Bhandari explains. “By the fiftieth, it's as if a team member has been with the company for years.” The platform integrates with 6+ AI vendors and open-source models, maintains full audit trails, and was engineered for enterprise compliance from day one.

WHAT'S NEXT

Beyond building the platform, Bhandari has been invited to deliver keynotes and technical talks on agent architecture and memory systems — topics where established best practices are still being defined — and is serving as a lead judge for upcoming agentic AI competitions, evaluating teams attempting to solve the same reliability problems he has spent years working on.

For Bhandari, it's a shift from solving these problems inside large companies to contributing to how the broader industry thinks about them.

"Everyone is talking about AI agents," Bhandari says. "I'm focused on actually making them work.”